



Phase 5 | Vowel Sounds
Non-Fiction | Reader 9

Focus Sounds | **Review of Phase 5 Sounds**



beanstalkbooks.com



9 Review

Apex Predators



Written By Anna Kirschberg



Phase 5 - Vowel Sounds

ay	ou	ie	ea	oy	ir	ue	aw
wh	ph	ew	oe	au	ey	a-e	e-e
i-e	o-e	u-e					

Heart Words

Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	Other	
is	be	what	prey	ecosystems
the	you	do	primary	lions
of	are	so	secondary	Komodo
to	they	something	bears	changes
has	we	have	natural	population
no	there		tigers	their
as	by		why	producers
			who	herbivores
			know	carnivores



Teachers / Parents

These decodable readers have been written using a strictly controlled vocabulary. Text uses only **decodable regular words** (according to the week by week progression of Rainbow Phonics) along with '**Heart Words**'. Heart Words (common exception words) are frequently used words that are not decodable at this phase.

Phase Five - Non-Fiction (Life Science)

1. The Deep Sea
2. Birds and Beaks
3. Paws and Claws
4. What is an Elephant?
5. A Haul of Honey
6. Soil is Alive!
7. Name the Bone
8. Your Brain, Your Supercomputer
9. Apex Predators
10. Extreme Environments
11. Reptiles, Hot or Cold?
12. Seeds on the Move

Word Count: 284

Apex Predators

© Beanstalk Books 2024.

All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise, without the permission in writing from Beanstalk Books.

Written by Anna Kirschberg. Photographs supplied by www.dreamstime.com.
Published by Beanstalk Books, PO Box 28-312, Remuera, Auckland, 1054.

Distributed in the United States by Junior Learning, Inc., 19744 Beach Blvd, #389, Huntington Beach, CA 92648.

Distributed in Australia by Junior Learning AUS, PO Box 6163 Yatala, Queensland, 4027.

Distributed in New Zealand by Junior Learning NZ, PO Box 28-312, Remuera, Auckland, 1054.

Distributed in the United Kingdom by Junior Learning UK, Third Floor, 207 Regent Street, London, W1B 3HH.

ISBN: 979-8-88742-829-1

Printed in China

beanstalkbooks.com

BB173



Apex Predators



Apex predators keep population numbers of their prey in check. Apex predators provide balance to food chains, habitats and ecosystems.



Review



Eat or be eaten. That is the mantra of the animal kingdom. You might understand what a food chain is and what a predator is, but do you know what an apex predator is? What are they and why are they so important to our ecosystems and food chains?



The population of an apex predator is limited by how much food is available. Top level predators play a key role in controlling the population of other animals, and this can impact the food chain.



Apex predators are carnivores and noted for their size, strength, speed and hunting ability. They attack their prey to feed. They have great senses like hearing and smell. They have sharp claws or jaws. And they have speed!



Plants sit at the bottom of the food chain. Plants are producers. Next, we have the herbivores who eat the plants, the primary consumers. Further up, we have the animals that eat the herbivores, the secondary consumers. At the top of the food chain, sits the apex predators.



'Apex' refers to the top of something. An apex predator is an animal that is at the top of a food chain and has no natural predators. Nothing eats the apex predators. Examples of apex predators include bears and polar bears, whale sharks, crocodiles, komodo dragons, tigers and lions.



Why are apex predators important? Apex predators are important to ecosystems. They have big effects on animals and plants in the food chain. If an apex predator becomes extinct in a habitat, there can be detrimental changes further down the food chain as a result.